

Take an AI feature to leadership

The brief, the fence, and the hundred points. Read this once now, and again after your first draft. Every number in the worked example attached to this module came out of a lesson you have already watched, so you can check the working.

1 — 2 — 3

WHAT YOU SHIP · ONE PAGE AND FIVE MINUTES

A one-page decision memo for **one real AI feature**, and a five-minute walkthrough you can defend. Not a status update, not a demo. **The room is buying your judgement; the feature is the evidence.**

THE BRIEF · WHAT YOU ARE BEING ASKED TO DO

You have a spec (Module 6), a rubric and a number (Module 7), and an agent design with a gate in it (Module 8). All three are written in the language of the work. The room upstairs asks four questions in a different language: **is it good, what does it cost, what happens when it is wrong, and what are you asking me for**. The capstone is that translation, plus the nerve to lead with the number that is against you.

THE PAGE · SIX BLOCKS, AND THE ORDER IS THE TEACHING

BLOCK 1

The decision

One decision, one date, one owner, one sized ask, inside the first two lines.

BLOCK 2

What it does

The one flow, in a sentence a non-user follows. Not the architecture.

BLOCK 3

Is it good

The set, the rubric, the number you got by running it, the bar you wrote first.

BLOCK 4

What it costs

Per request, at volume, what makes it ten times bigger, the lever, the latency a user feels.

BLOCK 5

When it is wrong

The worst plausible wrong action, where the person stands, what it may not touch, what you tested.

BLOCK 6

What you do not know

Two or three, each with what would settle it. And what would make you kill it.

Under it: an appendix with your working. Almost nobody opens it. It changes the meeting anyway, because you can.

WHAT YOU BUILD IT ON

One real AI feature you are close to: on your roadmap, in a vendor's pitch to you, or one you want to propose and have never had the evidence for. Real beats tidy — the judgement block is impossible to write about a feature you have no feel for.

IF NOTHING AT WORK FITS · THE FALLBACK BRIEF

Rowan · the First Week Coach. Rowan is the consumer personal-finance app from the Core capstone: £6.99 a month, 140,000 subscribers, 38 people, monthly churn 6.2%, and an activation problem — about half of new subscribers have one active week or fewer in their first month. The proposal on the table: in a new subscriber's first seven days, an assistant reads their connected transactions and sends **one specific plain-English nudge a day** ("you have spent thirty one pounds on takeaway this week; your eating-out budget has nine pounds left").

Your job: decide whether to build it, at what scope, for a date you name — and defend that in five minutes. Three things make it harder than it looks: it runs for every new subscriber whether they engage or not, so the cost shape is nothing like an assistant you ask; a wrong number is about somebody's money, and a push notification cannot be recalled, so the gate has to be somewhere other than the send; and "helpful" is not a quality bar — the rows that matter are whether every figure traces to a real transaction, whether the timeframe is right, and whether it avoids moralising. Inputs: the Rowan pack and the cancel-flow CSV from the Core capstone. **No worked Rowan answer is published.**

THREE WAYS GOOD WORK DIES

01

The status update

Everything that happened, beautifully organised, no decision asked for. "Thanks, keep us posted" is a no with better manners.

02

The demo

It worked once, on stage, on the happy path. The room has seen that run before, from a vendor.

03

The flattering number

The offline score without the real-traffic one that contradicts it. Survives the meeting, not the quarter, and costs you the only thing you were building: being believed next time.

THE FENCE · MARKED DOWN IF PRESENT

your employer's customer names

internal numbers

an architecture slide

a demo instead of a decision

an ask for "alignment"

a quality claim with no set behind it

Lesson 2.7 has not stopped applying. Anonymise, or run the capstone on Slotline or Rowan.

Nobody in that room is buying a feature. They are buying your judgement, and the feature is the evidence.

How you will be assessed

Score yourself honestly before you book the meeting. The row people lose points on is not the one they expect.

THE SCORECARD · 100 POINTS · SCORE YOURSELF BEFORE ANYONE ELSE DOES

ROW	FULL MARKS LOOKS LIKE	PTS	YOURS
THE DECISION	One named decision, a date, an owner, and an ask sized in people or money. A reader who stops after two lines knows what you want from them. Nothing here is a status update.	20	___ / 20
QUALITY, EVIDENCED	A set of examples, a rubric with rows, a number you produced by running it, and a ship bar written down before you saw the number. The least flattering number on the page sits above the most flattering one. Failure counts ranked.	25	___ / 25
UNIT ECONOMICS	Cost per request from real token counts, cost at a volume you can defend, what would make it ten times bigger, and the lever you would pull. Latency as the user experiences it, not time to first token.	20	___ / 20
RISK AND CONTROL	The worst plausible wrong action named concretely, placed on severity and reversibility, a gate at the point of no return (or an argued reason there is none), the capabilities you withheld, and evidence you tested it — including one attempt to make it misbehave.	20	___ / 20
JUDGEMENT	What would make you kill it. What you still do not know, and what would settle each. One place you overrode the model, and why. Almost nobody fills this in. It is the part a hiring manager reads twice.	15	___ / 15

85 TO 100

Take it to the real room

This is a decision pack. Book the slot.

70 TO 84

One block is thin

Usually quality or judgement. Two hours fixes it.

UNDER 70

You have a status update

Go back to move 1 and write the decision sentence.

THE FIVE MINUTES · THE ORDER THAT ROOM'S ATTENTION ACTUALLY RUNS IN

0:00 · 1:00	The decision. The ask, in one sentence, before anything else. No screen is up yet.
1:00 · 2:30	The evidence. The worse number first, then the better one, then the ranked counts.
2:30 · 3:30	Cost. Per request, at volume, the ten-times risk, the lever.
3:30 · 4:30	Risk. The worst wrong action, the gate, what it may not touch, what you tested.
4:30 · 5:00	The ask. Repeat the decision, the date and the owner. Get them written down.

You will be interrupted in beat two, every time. That is why the ask comes first: cut off after any beat, the room still knows what you want.

TIME BUDGET · ABOUT FOUR HOURS, IN TWO SITTINGS

1 assemble and decide, 30 min · 2 the number that is against you, 60 min · 3 the money, 45 min · 4 when it is wrong, 45 min · 5 the page and the five minutes, 60 min. Lesson AC.2 carries the prompts and the self-checks.

ATTACHED TO THIS MODULE

This brief · the AC.2 worksheet · the one-pager template · **the worked solution on Slotline** (the memo as sent, annotated, and the script) · the final checkpoint quiz.